

Passages - Oedipus at Colonus

Time, Time, my friend,
Makes havoc everywhere; he is invincible.
Only the gods have ageless and deathless
life;

All else must perish. The sap of earth dries
up, Flesh dies, and while faith withers
falsehood blooms.

The spirit is not constant from friend to
friend, From city to city; it changes, soon
or late;

Joy turns to sorrow, and turns again to joy.
Between you and Thebes the sky is fair;
but Time Has many and many a night and
day to run On his uncounted course; in one
of these

Some little rift will come, and the sword's
point Will make short work of this day's
harmony.

Then my cold body in its secret sleep
Shall drink hot blood.

Law arms the weaker, when the cause is
just.

Evil intentions betray themselves in
speech.

Show me the man who asks an over-
abundant share Of life, in love with more,
and ill content With less, and I will show
you one in love With foolishness.

In the accumulation of many years
Pain is in plenty, and joy not anywhere